migrants' moved to Britain, and to a lesser extent also to Canada and America.[23]

Since the 1980s, Indians have been wooed back to East Africa by subsequent political rulers, in appreciation of their economic contribution. Many have gone back. Currently, around 2,00,000 people of Indian origin live in East Africa. But many settled and succeeded abroad. In the USA, they can lock eyes again with the Tsavo lions of the Uganda Railway fame, as two of them are displayed at the Field Museum in Chicago.

Around 4000 km south of East Africa, Indians were a part of a very different landscape, creating a very different kind of history. Instead of predatory lions, there were discriminatory laws, and instead of Punjabis, there were Tamilians and Bhojpuris. What was common between East Africa and South Africa were the Gujarati traders, and it was in that context that a young Gujarati by the name of Mohandas Gandhi arrived as a qualified lawyer in Durban, Natal, aboard the *S.S. Admiral* on 24 May 1893. Apart from fighting court cases for traders, he immersed himself in the realities of South African discrimination and the fight for the rights of Indians. He would witness the plight of indentured Indian labour first-hand because between 1860 and 1911, around 1,50,000 such migrant workers were brought to Natal, along the east coast of South Africa, to work on sugar plantations. Around half of them stayed back.[24] Most migrant workers were male and drawn from the core zones of the Great Indian Migration Wave—60 per cent were from the Tamil and Telugu-speaking parts of south India and the rest were from the Bhojpuri-speaking tracts of north India. In contrast with East Africa, Gujarati traders followed the labour migration rather than the other way round, but as in East Africa, they followed the newly constructed railway lines to extend their trading posts and drew the ire of the locals.

The prominence of a nascent Indian middle class in Natal angered the White South Africans, who passed a raft of legislations against the Indians after Natal achieved the status of self-government in 1893. Racist legislations against the Indians and Africans gained more currency in subsequent decades, restricting settlement, migration and business. In